



Calm Home Skills

Premium practice worksheet

CALM HOME SKILLS - LESSON 01

Teach calm to happen on purpose.

Use this worksheet to help your dog shift from active to settled, build recovery after excitement, and make calm behavior easier to repeat at home.

TRAINER NOTE

Dogs do not automatically know how to “turn off.” Calm is a skill that improves with practice, environment, and timing.

START HERE

Dog: _____

Date: _____

Owner: _____

Best reward: _____

1 What success looks like

By the end of this lesson, the owner can create a short settle routine, reinforce relaxed body language, and help the dog recover more quickly after activity.

2 Practice plan

1

Capture calm

Reward your dog for lying down, softening, sighing, or settling on their own.

2

Build a settle routine

Guide your dog to the mat, pause, reward calm, and keep the pattern boring and

3

Reinforce small wins

Reward brief moments of stillness before your dog pops back up.

4

Increase duration slowly

Add a little time only after your dog can remain relaxed on easy reps.



Calm Home Skills

Building an Off-Switch

3 Supplies and setup

Supplies needed

- ☐ Comfortable mat or bed
- ☐ Soft treats or calm chews
- ☐ Quiet area with low foot traffic
- ☐ Leash or tether if it helps the setup stay clear

Set up before you start

- ☐ Practice after potty and a bit of movement, not at peak zoomies.
- ☐ Choose one calm spot and use it consistently.
- ☐ Keep your own body language quiet and predictable.

4 Settle and off-switch tracker

Date	Setup	Duration	Body language	What helped	Next step

5 5-day practice micro plan

Day 1

Set baseline

Find the easiest version and keep it calm.

Day 2

Repeat wins

Practice the same setup until it looks smooth.

Day 3

Add one tiny step

Add only one small challenge if yesterday

Day 4

Hold or simplify

If your puppy struggled, make today easier.

Day 5

Review notes

Choose the safest next step from your log.



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6 Common mistakes and quick fixes

Common mistakes

- Asking for calm when the dog still has unmet exercise or potty needs.
- Rewarding only after the dog gets restless again.
- Talking too much or hovering during settle practice.
- Expecting long duration before the dog understands the pattern.

If this happens, try this

- If the dog pops up quickly, reward sooner and shorten the rep.
- If the dog paces, lower stimulation and simplify the environment.
- If calm is hard after exciting play, add a decompression walk or sniffing break first.

7 Ready to progress?

- ☐ My dog has a clear settle spot.
- ☐ I can recognize relaxed vs. restless body language.
- ☐ I am rewarding calm early enough.
- ☐ I know the easiest duration my dog can handle successfully.

HOMEWORK

Practice two short settle sessions per day for five days. Record what time of day, what setup, and what reward helped your dog relax fastest.

8 Owner reflection

Biggest win: _____

What made it easier: _____

What should I repeat tomorrow: _____

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR FITDOG TRAINER

What should I make easier? _____

What should I practice again? _____

What is the next realistic step? _____